HALFTONE GARDEN / ISSUE 01

MAKE ROOM

A HANDMADE COMMUNITY DISPATCH



A handmade dispatch for the spaces between.

A SMALL INVITATION

This issue starts with a spare chair, a blank wall and a record waiting to be turned over. None of them asks for a grand plan. Each offers somewhere to begin.

Make room is our way of looking at independent culture: leave a gap for a new voice, give an unfinished idea a hearing, and make the next invitation easy to understand.

The conversation, bands and calendar in this issue are authored fiction. The methods are practical prompts. Read, borrow an approach and make your own dispatch.

03-06	The spare chair
07-10	The wall remembers
11-12	Noticeboard
13-16	One object, two views
17-18	The extra chair
19-20	Small signals
21-22	Make a dispatch
23	Colophon

THE SPARE CHAIR

PULL UP

A fictional dialogue with Mara Vale, imagined organiser of the Lantern Room.

HG: What comes before a programme?
MV: A reason to gather. We imagined a room where a first attempt could sit beside a finished piece without either needing an apology. The programme grew from that question.

HG: Why a spare chair?
MV: It keeps the room from becoming a closed picture. Someone can arrive without having appeared in the plan. The chair is a small promise: there is still space.

ASK A SMALLER QUESTION.



HG: How do you invite people without asking for too much?
MV: We begin with a specific question. Bring a page you keep returning to. Play one sound you made at home. Tell us which part is unresolved. A small request gives someone a way in.

HG: Does everything need to be public?
MV: No. A listening session can stay in the room. A draft can be shared with one reader. We would agree what can be photographed or repeated before the session starts. An invitation should explain those boundaries.

LEAVE THE EDGES OPEN.



HG: What makes a notice useful?
MV: The essentials need to survive the decoration: what is happening, where it is, when to arrive, what it costs and how to ask a question. We can make the title loud, but we cannot make the time a guessing game.

HG: And when the plan changes?
MV: Publish the correction where the original invitation appeared. A beautiful poster cannot do the work of a reliable update. Keep one current version and make its status obvious.

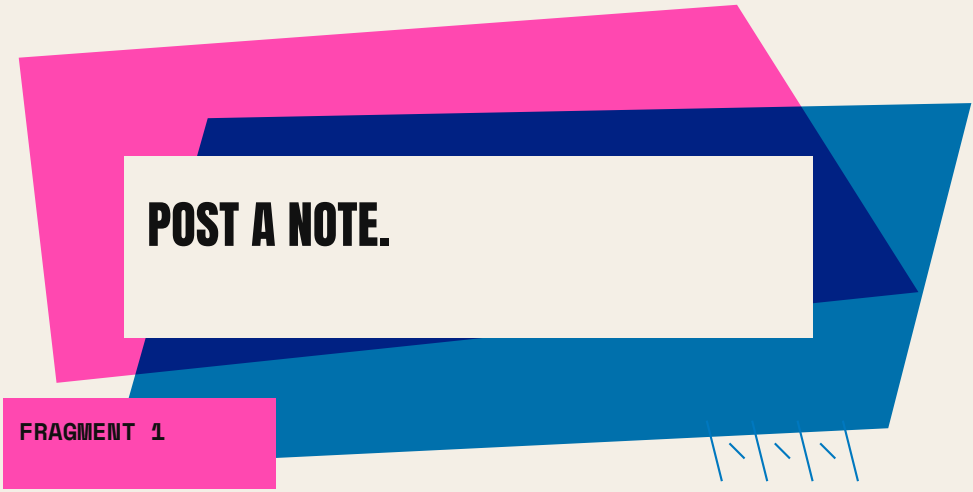
A ROOM IS A PRACTICE.

HG: What would you measure?
MV: Whether someone understood how to join. Whether the session started when promised. Whether the next organiser knew where the files were. Those are useful questions before chasing a bigger audience.

HG: What happens after everyone leaves?
MV: Put the chairs back, check what needs attention and write a short note for the next session. A room is a practice because care repeats. It cannot be finished by one good evening.

An authored dialogue, not a transcript or a claim about a real venue.

THE WALL REMEMBERS.



A wall of notices is a temporary archive. Dates pass, corners lift and one announcement sits over another. The surface records the effort of asking people to show up.

Our collage is drawn from scratch: paper shapes, live type and marks that can be moved again. It borrows the act of layering, not somebody else's poster.

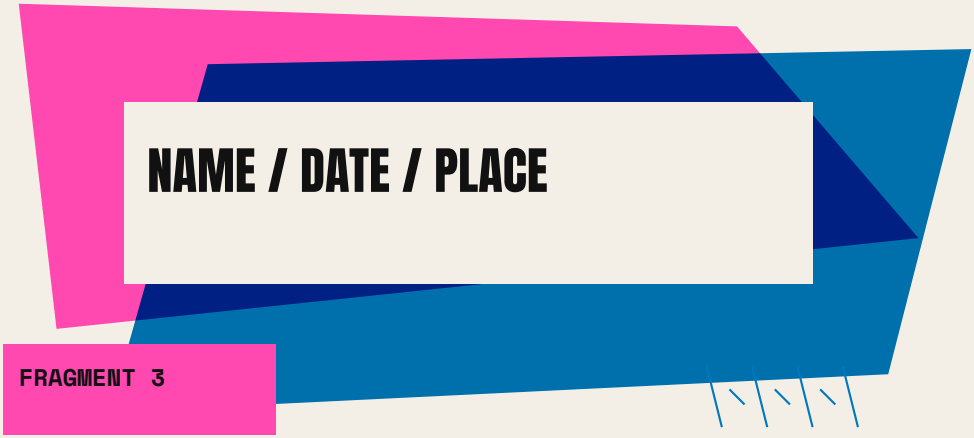
READ THE OVERLAP.



Layering can carry two stories at once. A new note says what happens next; a fragment beneath it says that the space has already been used. The overlap feels lively when both have a job.

For this issue, the pink and blue shapes meet with a controlled Multiply effect. The text sits above them at full contrast. This is process-colour artwork, not a claim about spot inks or tested overprint.

WHAT SURVIVES?



If a notice is glimpsed on the way past, what remains? A name, a date, a place. Make those pieces strong enough to survive a torn corner or a hurried reader.

The page can be irregular without being careless. Our recurring section label and folio stay in the same place while the collage changes. A reader should not need to learn a new route on every page.

SAVE A FRAGMENT.



Keep the piece that explains a decision: a first title, a revised time, a sketch of the route through the room. An archive of every abandoned file is hard to use; an archive of useful fragments can teach the next person.

Add a date, a credit and one sentence about what changed. Keep the source separate from the final export. A fragment becomes a record when somebody else can understand it.

HG / GIG-POSTER DEMONSTRATION

THE LANTERN SESSIONS

24 OCT / 18:00

WINDOW HUM / PAPER RADIO / LOW TIDE STATIC

One room. Three short sets.
Saturday 24 October 2026
Doors 18:00 / first set 18:30
Suggested contribution: GBP 5
Lantern Room, fictional North Lane

Authored gig-poster demonstration.
No event or ticket sale is available.

OCTOBER IN THE ROOM

An authored programme for the fictional Lantern Room. Dates and details form one model; this is not a listing of real events.

DATE	TIME	SESSION	BRING
10 OCT	14:00	Page exchange	Bring one draft
17 OCT	15:00	Listening table	One sound each
24 OCT	18:00	Lantern Sessions	Three short sets
31 OCT	13:00	Making afternoon	Fold a paper dummy

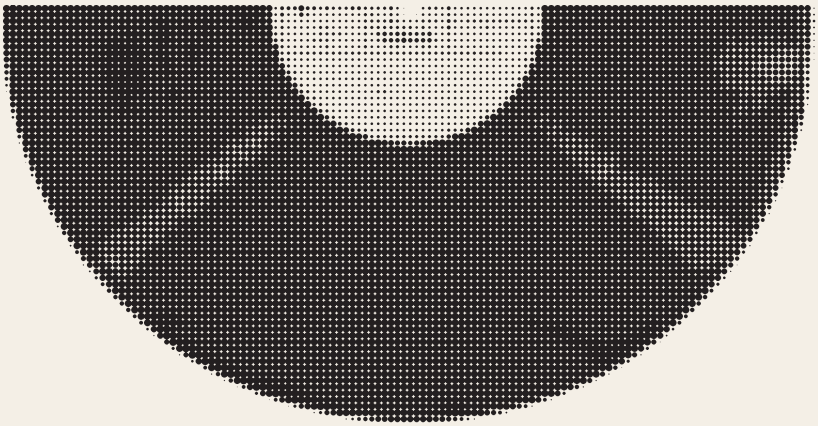
ONE OBJECT. TWO VIEWS.



A record is both a circle and a surface. One view reads its shape; another follows the grooves. The same photographer gives us a coherent pair to study.

Photographs: Miguel A. Padrinan / Pexels. No recording or artist endorsement is implied.

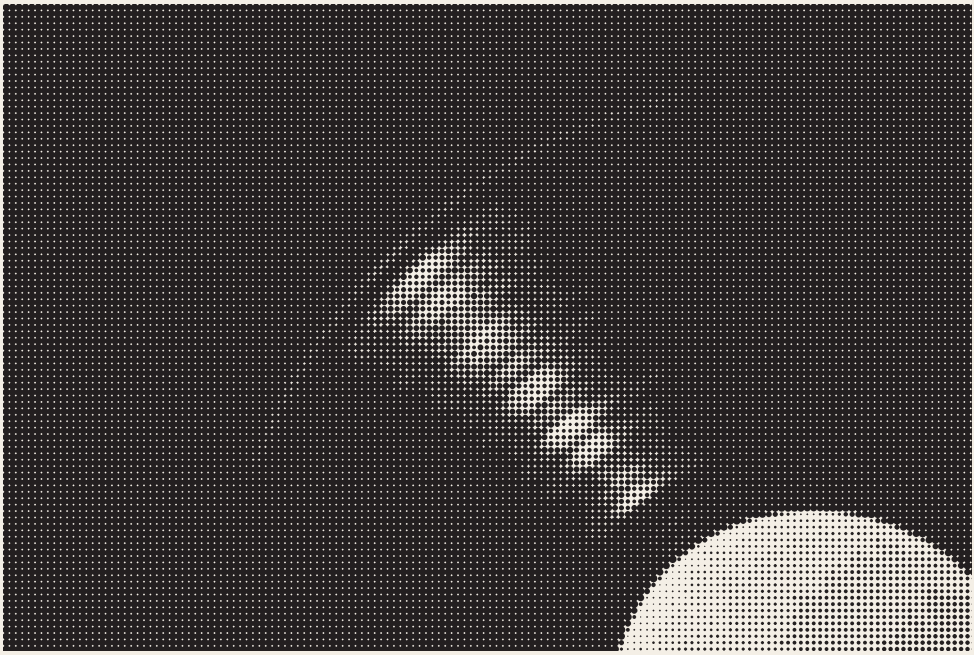
THE WHOLE CIRCLE



The first image keeps the outer edge in view. Space around the disc lets its shape do the work. Before adding a caption, look at where the eye enters and where it comes to rest.

Original photograph: Pexels 167092. Conventional bitmap-screen derivative.

FOLLOW THE GROOVE



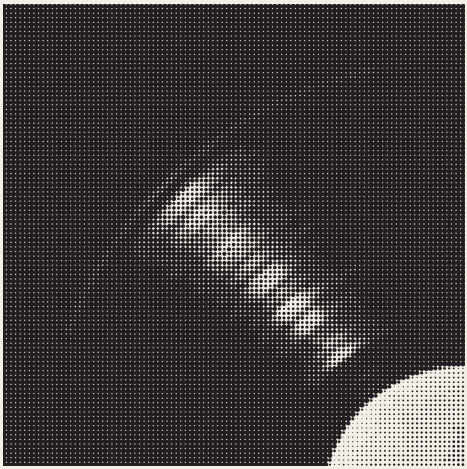
The second view moves close enough for the surface to become a field of lines. The crop changes the reading: the object becomes texture, rhythm and reflected light.

Original photograph: Pexels 3391930. Conventional bitmap-screen derivative.

DOTS KEEP THE RHYTHM.



CONTINUOUS TONE



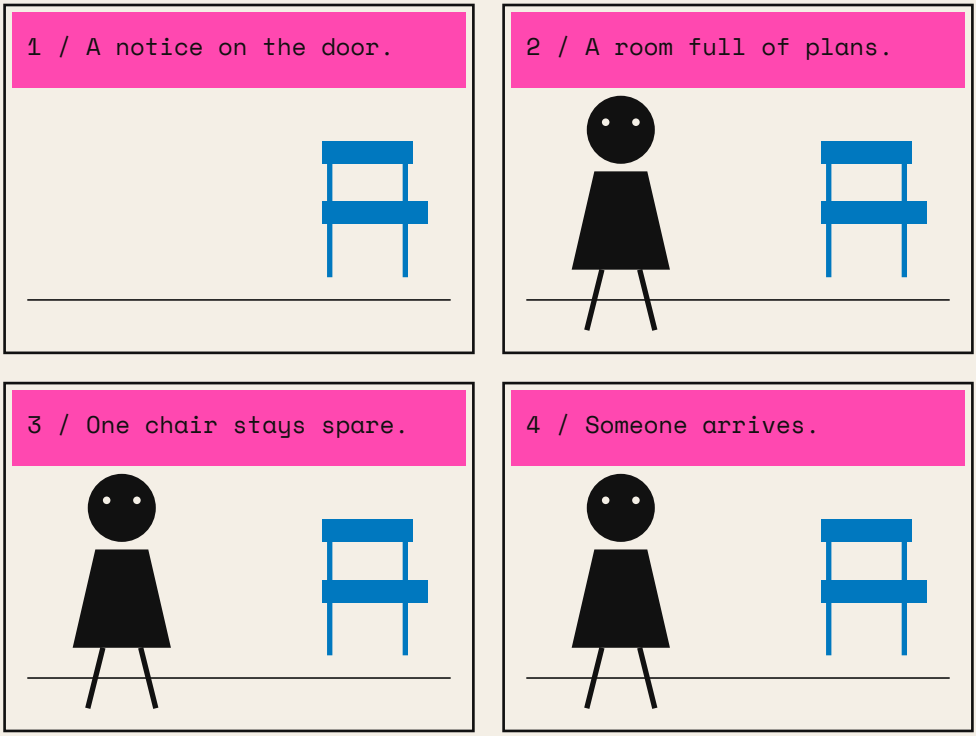
BITMAP SCREEN

A halftone translates tone into marks. Here, round dots vary with the source photograph; the screen is a conventional, non-generative bitmap transformation.

Compare the continuous-tone crop with the screened crop. Keep the original nearby, because texture should not erase the thing you were trying to show. Physical ink gain still needs a printer's proof.

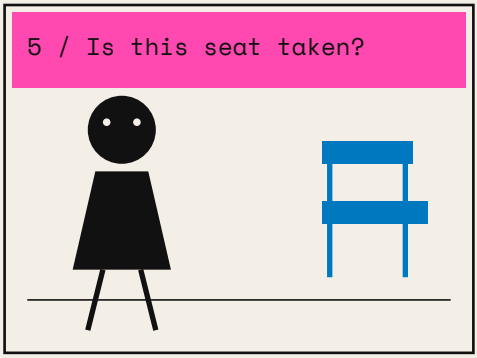
A QUIET ARRIVAL

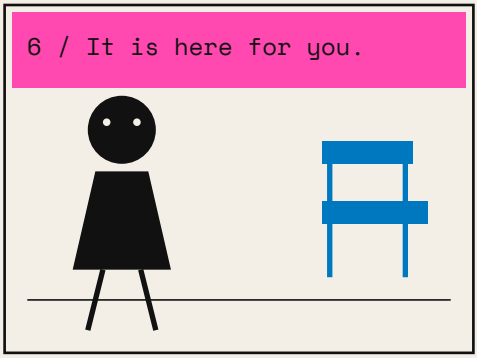
An original two-page comic drawn as editable InDesign paths and live lettering.

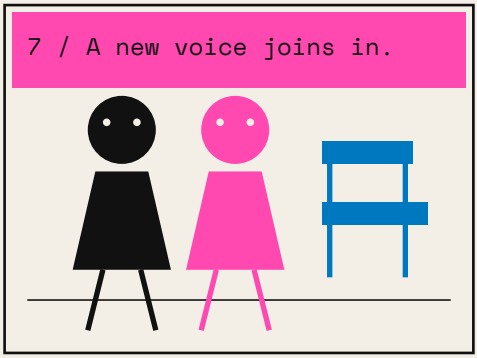


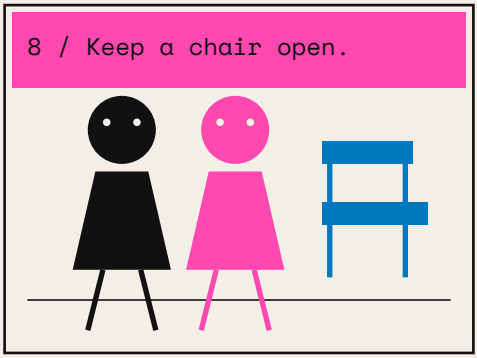
THE ROOM GETS BIGGER.

The invitation changes when someone new can see where to sit.









SIDE A / SIDE B

An invented listening sequence. The acts and track names are fictional; these are mood notes, not reviews of released recordings.

A1	Window Hum / Spare Key	**03:10**
A2	Paper Radio / North Lane	**02:45**
A3	Low Tide Static / After the Chairs	**04:05**
B1	Window Hum / Open Door	**02:50**
B2	Paper Radio / Folded Note	**03:20**
B3	Low Tide Static / Room Tone	**03:00**

TOTAL RUNNING TIME / 19:10

SMALL SIGNALS

Three imagined releases, read as exercises in attention. No real artist, recording or critical endorsement is represented.

WINDOW HUM / SPARE KEY

A small imaginary release built around repetition. Our review prompt: notice when a repeated phrase begins to feel like a place.

PAPER RADIO / FOLDED NOTE

An imagined pair of contrasting textures. Our review prompt: describe the change without reaching for a score.

LOW TIDE STATIC / ROOM TONE

A fictional study in the sound between events. Our review prompt: listen for the ending before deciding what the centre is.

BUILD A 24-PAGE DISPATCH.

PLAN

01 / Choose one question.
Write it at the top of your page map. Every section should help the reader approach it from a different angle.

02 / Count the pages.
A 24-page stapled booklet uses six folded sheets before any separate cover decisions. Make a numbered paper dummy and check the sequence.

03 / Give each page a job.
Plan an opener, a place to read, a reference page, a pause and a close. Do not ask every page to shout.

CHECK IT BEFORE YOU SHARE.

PROOF

04 / Keep the source.
Save the live text, original photographs, credits and working file. Export a clearly named review PDF.

05 / Read at actual size.
Look for cropped lines, weak contrast, cramped captions and gaps in the sequence. Ask another reader to find a date or a credit.

06 / Make a physical proof.
Check paper, fold, binding clearance and ink with the printer. A screen proof cannot confirm the feel of a finished booklet.

MADE OF SMALL DECISIONS.

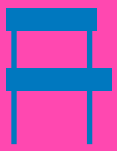
Original editorial, identity, layout, native collage, comic and poster artwork: Ayobami.

Photography: Miguel A. Padrinan / Pexels, images 167092 and 3391930. Used under the Pexels License; conventional crops and bitmap halftone derivatives.

Type: Anton and Space Mono / Google Fonts, SIL Open Font License.

The people, venue, events, acts, tracks and releases are authored fiction. No interview, event or release is claimed. This is a process-colour edition with controlled Multiply effects. Physical printing, binding and colour proof remain pending.

KEEP A CHAIR OPEN.



HALFTONE GARDEN
Issue 01 / Make room
24 pages / A5
A handmade community dispatch.